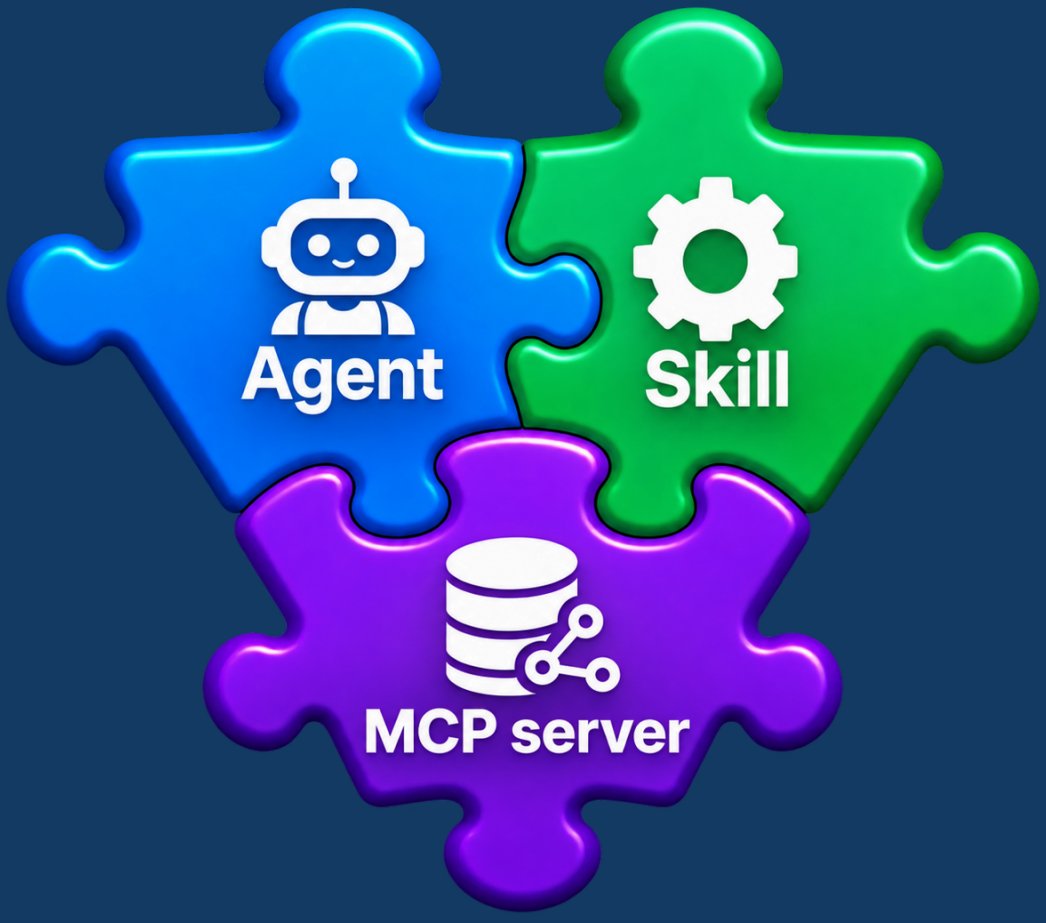
PARTICIPANT SETUP GUIDE

Microsoft Global AI Activation Event

Sponsored by Microsoft Windows and Developer Azure Services



Contents

Click a line to jump to that section.

1. Create a GitHub account page 3
2. Install Visual Studio Code page 3
3. Sign in to GitHub Copilot Chat page 3
4. Install Python page 3
5. Get the LLM API key page 4
6. Set the runtime environment variables page 4
7. Vibe code page 5



1. Create a GitHub account

Do this before you install Visual Studio Code. GitHub Copilot Chat signs in with a GitHub account. If you already have one, skip to the next section.

- Open https://github.com/signup.
- Use an email you can open during the event.
- Finish the verification GitHub sends you.

2. Install Visual Studio Code

GitHub Copilot Chat is already included in the current Visual Studio Code download. You do not install it separately.

- Download: https://code.visualstudio.com/download.
- Pick the Windows installer.
- Run the installer and accept the defaults.
- Open Visual Studio Code once so it finishes setup.

3. Sign in to GitHub Copilot Chat

Copilot Chat is already in Visual Studio Code from the install in section 2. This step is only the sign-in. You do not enable or install an extension. You do not need an LLM API key while Copilot is building the project.

- Open Visual Studio Code.
- Look at the bottom left corner of the window. That is the Accounts icon.
- Click the Accounts icon.
- Choose Sign in with GitHub, or Sign in to use GitHub Copilot.
- The browser opens. Sign in with the GitHub account from section 1 and allow Visual Studio Code.
- Return to Visual Studio Code. The bottom left should show that you are signed in.
- Open Copilot Chat from the Copilot icon at the top right. If the panel is already open, leave it open.

4. Install Python

Install a stable release of Python before the event. A pre-release version is not needed.

· Download: https://www.python.org/downloads/windows/

· Under Stable Releases, select a current stable Python release for Windows.

· Run the Windows installer. Enable Add Python to PATH if offered.

· Complete the installation and open Command Prompt.

· Verify the installation by running: python --version

· No Python extension or virtual environment is required for this event.

5. Get the LLM API key

An LLM API key is needed to connect to the LLM when the application runs. There is no preferred vendor. Commonly used providers are OpenAI, Anthropic, Groq, or any other LLM provider of your choice.

· OpenAI (paid): https://platform.openai.com/api-keys.

· Anthropic (paid): https://platform.claude.com/settings/keys.

· Groq (free API key): https://console.groq.com/keys.

6. Set the runtime environment variables

Set two runtime environment variables: LLM_API_KEY and LLM_PROVIDER. These are used when you run the Python agent, not while Copilot is writing the files. Set these environment variables before running any application. Restart Visual Studio Code afterward.

Continue with the Windows setup steps on the next page.

On your Windows machine:

- Press the Windows key and search for environment variables.
- Open Edit the system environment variables, then click Environment Variables.
- Under System variables, click New.
- Variable name: LLM_API_KEY. Variable value: your API key. Click OK.
- Click New again.
- Variable name: LLM_PROVIDER. Variable value (choose the provider name that matches your API key; enter only one of the following): openai, anthropic, or groq.
- Then click OK.
- Close the dialogs. If Visual Studio Code is already open, close it and reopen it.

7. Vibe code

The complete vibe coding instructions will be provided in the file Prompt-Agent-Skill-MCP-Event.txt, which will be available for download at the time of the live demo.

Download location:
https://github.com/TTexan2015/Event

Follow along with the presenter during the demo to use these instructions to build the application.